



A compilation of the Zeiss print ads over the years

What brought Nokia down was the launch of Apple's iPhone and the multitude of Android platform phones.



The Nokia N90

Both were based on software that was far superior to Nokia's Symbian OS. Even the Microsoft buyout did not help, because the launches post this were based on the not-so-popular Windows platform.

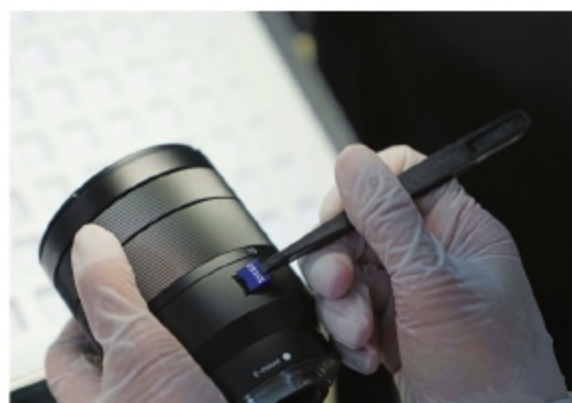
Nokia has made a recent attempt to come back on the Android platform with the Nokia 8, again with a Zeiss lens. At last count early this year, the company had managed to gain a little over 1 per cent of the global mobile phone market. While this is a far cry from its earlier



Nokia N95

high, it is a creditable reboot. The company has recently launched the Nokia 6.1 and 5.1. And while Apple and Android are far ahead, we will have to wait and watch to see if this attempted comeback by Nokia goes anywhere.

Zeiss and Sony: Well before the Nokia partnership was the Zeiss-Sony collaboration. This commenced in 1995, and is another great example of ingredient branding. Like Nokia, Sony too was not well-known for optics and photography. But since Sony was a reputable name with consumers, it used the expertise of Zeiss to launch a range of camcorders and digital cameras.



The first product launched under this partnership was the Sony Handycam CCD-TR555. Recently, the company has also launched lens-style cameras that can be attached to smartphones.



Nokia 808 PureView

Zeiss has supported Sony throughout the optical design and development process. It has tested and approved prototypes. It has also developed 25 of its own distinctive lenses that are a perfect fit for Sony cameras. This is how symbiotic this partnership is. And it has been an extremely successful one. The two firms celebrated 20 years of this partnership in 2015 and it is still going strong. They have sold over 185 million products through this collaboration, which continues even today.



The Zeiss-Sony Handycam CCD-TR555

Looking forward: Zeiss in the meantime is not depending too much on Nokia and Sony. It has four focus areas—semiconductor manufacturing technology that enables the manufacture of powerful microchips; medical technology used in products and solutions for ophthalmology, neurosurgery, ENT surgery, dentistry and oncology; precision equipment and microscope systems to ensure even the tiniest structures and processes become visible; and movie and camera lenses, binocular lenses, etc. The company is not only exploiting its core strength in lenses but has transferred this expertise into other industries as well.